

Pre-Listing Prep & Styling Checklist — Western Australia

Getting your property market-ready without overspending on the wrong things.

Correct as at July 2026. General information only, not legal, financial or valuation advice.

Section 1 — Before You Spend Anything

- ☐ [] **Engage your settlement agent or solicitor early** to prepare your contract of sale — since WA has no cooling-off period, having a clean, complete contract ready before marketing begins helps buyers move to signature with confidence.
- ☐ [] **Get a professional appraisal from 2-3 agents** before deciding your preparation budget.
- ☐ [] **Decide: renovate, style, or sell as-is?** Major renovations rarely return their cost dollar-for-dollar in a short pre-sale timeframe.

Section 2 — High-Return, Low-Cost Improvements

- ☐ [] **Declutter aggressively** — consistently the highest-return, lowest-cost step.
- ☐ [] **Deep clean throughout**, including often-overlooked areas.
- ☐ [] **Fix small, visible defects** — leaking taps, cracked tiles, chipped paint.
- ☐ [] **Freshen paint in neutral tones** where walls are marked or dated.
- ☐ [] **Improve street appeal**, particularly relevant in Perth's warmer, drier climate where gardens can look neglected quickly if not maintained pre-listing.

Section 3 — Styling Decisions

- ☐ [] **Consider professional staging for vacant properties.**
- ☐ [] **For occupied properties, focus on de-personalising** rather than full staging.
- ☐ [] **Get professional photography and floor plans regardless of styling budget** — not an area to cut costs on.
- ☐ [] **Ask your agent for their honest opinion on styling ROI** for your specific property.

Section 4 — Compliance Items to Check Before Listing

- ☐ [] **Check smoke alarm compliance.**
- ☐ [] **If in a strata scheme, gather your records** — recent meeting minutes, financials, and any known disputes or special levies, which buyers' settlement agents will request.
- ☐ [] **Address any known structural or building issues honestly** — a clean contract and disclosure process helps buyers move quickly to signature given there's no cooling-off period to iron out surprises afterward.

Section 5 — Timing Your Campaign

- ☐ [] **Discuss timing with your agent relative to market conditions.**
- ☐ [] **Align your preparation timeline with your agent's proposed campaign start.**
- ☐ [] **Plan your own moving logistics in parallel** — see the separate Pre-Settlement Checklist in this series.

Quick Reference — Where to Spend, Where to Save

HIGH-RETURN, LOW-COST	OFTEN LOWER-RETURN RELATIVE TO COST
Decluttering	Full kitchen/bathroom renovations
Deep cleaning	High-end fixture upgrades
Minor repairs	Structural changes shortly before sale
Professional photography	Extensive landscaping overhauls
Fresh neutral paint (where needed)	Full furniture replacement for occupied homes

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